

English Homework

Ahmet — Lesson 5 Follow-Up

Vocabulary · Grammar · Hedging · Writing

Estimated time: **1.5 hours** Teacher: **Khan Ahsan** Date: **March 2026**

Today's goals: (1) Build vocabulary from your speaking topics (2) Fix your most common grammar mistakes (3) Practise hedging — your new superpower! (4) Write one short paragraph

PART A Vocabulary

(*≈ 30 min*)

A1 — Words from Your Last Lesson

These words came up in our class. Study each one carefully, then do the exercises below.

Word	<i>Example sentence</i>	Meaning
gravitate towards	<i>People gravitate towards well-known brands.</i>	to be naturally attracted to something
closure	<i>The closure of local shops harmed the community.</i>	the act of shutting something permanently
extent	<i>To what extent do you agree?</i>	the degree or level of something
promote	<i>Companies promote their products online.</i>	to advertise; to support the growth of something
integrity	<i>I would never lose my integrity for money.</i>	strong moral principles; honesty
promotion	<i>They spent millions on marketing and promotion.</i>	activities to advertise a product
expand / expansion	<i>The rapid expansion of supermarkets hurt small shops.</i>	to grow bigger; the process of growing
compete	<i>Small businesses cannot compete with supermarkets.</i>	to try to be better or more successful than others
encourage	<i>The government should encourage local businesses.</i>	to give support and confidence to someone
transparent	<i>Companies should be transparent about their prices.</i>	open and honest; easy to understand

A2 — Fill in the Blanks

Use the words from the table above. Use the correct form of the word.

1. Due to the development and rapid _____ of supermarkets, many small shops had to close.
2. Many people _____ buying products they see advertised on social media.

3. The _____ of local businesses will bring about the death of local communities.
4. I personally believe that companies should be more _____ about their prices.
5. To what _____ do you agree that advertising is unnecessary for a good product?
6. I would rather lose money than lose my _____.
7. The government should _____ local businesses rather than foreign ones.
8. Small shops simply cannot _____ with companies that spend millions on _____.

A3 — Match the Synonyms

Draw a line to match each word on the left with its synonym on the right.

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. gravitate towards | a. shut down |
| 2. encourage | b. be attracted to |
| 3. closure | c. support / motivate |
| 4. promote | d. level / degree |
| 5. extent | e. advertise / market |

A4 — Vocabulary in Context

Write your own sentence using each word below. Think about the IELTS topics from class.

1. **compete:**

2. **integrity:**

3. **gravitate towards:**

PART B Grammar Fix

(≈ 25 min)

These are the grammar points where you made mistakes in class. Don't worry — these are very common! Study the rules, then do the exercises.

B1 — Subject–Verb Agreement

Rule

A singular subject takes a singular verb. A plural subject takes a plural verb.

The company **have** big budgets.

The company **has** big budgets.

Many small business **are** unable...

Many small businesses **are** unable...

Correct the verb or noun in each sentence. Write the correct sentence on the line.

1. Large businesses has a big budget for marketing.

2. Many small local business are unable to compete.

3. The government should focus on encouraging local business rather than foreign business.

4. Online meetings have some advantages and disadvantages.

B2 — Articles: *a*, *an*, *the*, or *nothing* (Ø)

Rule

- Use **a** / **an** the first time you mention something new.
- Use **the** when the listener already knows what you are talking about.
- Use **nothing** (Ø) before plural or uncountable nouns when speaking generally.

I have **a** notebook at home. **The** notebook is very useful.

Ø Advertising is important for Ø new businesses.

*Fill in the blank with **a**, **an**, **the**, or Ø (nothing).*

1. _____ government should control _____ salaries of its citizens.
2. I had _____ amazing time visiting _____ Grand Canyon.

3. Companies should spend money on _____ social activities for _____ local communities.
4. _____ closure of _____ local businesses is _____ serious problem.
5. My son studied _____ information technology at _____ university.

B3 — Tense Consistency

Rule

Do not mix past and present tense in the same story. If you start in the past, stay in the past.

He graduated in 2017 and then he starts working at a company.

*He graduated in 2017 and then he **started** working at a company.*

Find and correct the tense mistake in each sentence.

1. In 2017, my son goes to the United States to study at a university.

2. She graduated from nursing school and then she starts to work at the same hospital.

3. We visited the Grand Canyon and it is the most amazing place I had ever seen.

PART C Hedging — Your New Superpower! (≈ 25 min)

Hedging = making your statements less direct and more polite. It shows social intelligence. Native speakers hedge all the time, even when they are 100% certain. It is NOT lying. It is NOT being weak. It is being **smart and professional**.

C1 — Hedging Phrases to Learn by Heart

Hedging phrase	What it replaces
I think / I believe	This is (wrong / right / bad...)
It seems to me that...	Obviously / Clearly ...
I'm not sure if I agree...	You are wrong.
This might not be entirely correct.	This is wrong.
From my perspective...	The truth is...
We might want to look at...	We must change this.
I'm not sure this would work in practice.	This will never work.
It appears to me that...	Clearly...
I could be wrong, but...	I am 100% certain that...

C2 — Transform the Sentences

Rewrite each sentence using hedging. You can use any phrase from the table above.

1. **Direct:** Your plan will never work.
Hedged:

2. **Direct:** Advertising is a waste of money.

Hedged:

3. **Direct:** The government is wrong to allow foreign companies in our country.

Hedged:

4. **Direct:** Online shopping will destroy local businesses.

Hedged:

5. **Direct:** Your idea is completely wrong.

Hedged:

C3 — Spot the Hedging

Read the paragraph below and underline every hedging phrase you can find.

“From my perspective, the closure of local businesses seems to be a serious problem for communities. I think it is possible that when large supermarkets expand, many small shops might struggle to survive. I could be wrong, but it appears to me that governments should perhaps consider offering financial support to local businesses. We might also want to look at encouraging people to buy local products. I’m not entirely sure this would solve every problem, but it seems like a reasonable starting point.”

How many hedging phrases did you find? _____

PART D Writing Practice

(≈ 10 min)

Your Writing Task

Write **5–8 sentences** about one of the topics from our class today. Use at least:

- **3 vocabulary words** from Part A
- **2 hedging phrases** from Part C
- Correct article and subject-verb agreement

Choose one topic:

- Should governments limit how much people can earn?
- What are the advantages and disadvantages of online shopping?
- Should companies support local communities?

Topic I chose: _____

Remember: You are doing great, Ahmet! Using your notes during the lesson (like “I would rather...”) was fantastic. Keep that habit. Practice makes perfect. See you after Eid!